

The 15-Minute Diabetic Indian Kitchen: Fast Cooking Hacks

"I don't have time to cook healthy Indian food" is the biggest excuse for ordering takeout or eating highly processed food.

By dedicating just 2 hours on Sunday to meal prep, you can cook fresh, hot, diabetic-friendly Indian meals from scratch in under 15 minutes during the busy workweek.

■ The Sunday 2-Hour Prep Routine

Spend your Sunday afternoon doing these 4 things. Put on some music or a podcast.

1. The "Base Bhuna Masala" (Saves 20 mins per meal)

Every Indian gravy starts with onions, tomatoes, ginger, and garlic.

- **The Hack:** Finely chop 10 onions and 10 tomatoes. Heat mustard oil, add jeera, then fry the onions until deeply brown. Add ginger-garlic paste, then the tomatoes and basic dry spices (Haldi, Dhania, Mirch). Cook until oil separates.
- **Storage:** Let it cool, pack it into 4-5 small glass jars, and freeze them (keep one in the fridge).
- **Weekday Usage:** When you want to make Chicken, Paneer, or Sabzi, just heat 2 spoons of this base masala, add your main ingredient, add water, and boil!

2. Prepare the "Diabetic Dough" (Saves 10 mins per meal)

- **The Hack:** Mix 1 kg of Whole Wheat Atta with 500g of Besan (Chickpea flour) and 250g of Jowar flour. Knead a large batch of this dough using warm water and a little oil.
- **Storage:** Store in an airtight steel or glass container in the fridge.
- **Weekday Usage:** Roll out fresh, low-GI rotis immediately when needed. No measuring or kneading required during the week.

3. Wash, Chop, and Store Veggies (Saves 15 mins per meal)

- **The Hack:** Wash and chop cabbage, cauliflower florets, bhindi, and beans.
- **Storage:** Ensure they are *completely dry*. Store them in zip-lock bags or Tupperware lined with a paper towel (to absorb moisture).
- **Weekday Usage:** Throw them directly from the box into your pan.

4. Boil the Beans and Pulses (Saves 40 mins per meal)

- **The Hack:** Pressure cook a large batch of Rajma, Kala Chana, or Lobia (Black-eyed peas) on Sunday.
- **Storage:** Store them in the fridge without adding salt (adding salt reduces shelf life).
- **Weekday Usage:** Sauté with onions or use your Base Masala, and they are ready in 5 minutes!

■ 15-Minute Recipe Ideas for Busy Weekdays

1. 5-Minute Soya Keema Matar

1. Soak Soya granules in hot water for 3 mins. Squeeze out the water.
2. Heat a pan, add 2 large spoons of your "Base Bhuna Masala".
3. Add a handful of frozen peas and the Soya granules.
4. Stir fry for 2 minutes. Garnish with coriander. Done!

2. 10-Minute Stir-Fried Paneer & Capsicum

1. Take out chopped capsicum from the fridge. Cut paneer into cubes.
2. Heat oil, add jeera and a spoon of Base Masala.
3. Toss in the capsicum and paneer. Add salt and pepper.
4. Sauté for 5-7 minutes until the paneer is golden. Serve with 2 pre-made dough rotis.

3. 5-Minute "No-Bread" Besan Chilla

1. Mix 1 cup of Besan with water, salt, ajwain, and finely chopped veggies (you chopped them on Sunday!).
2. Heat a non-stick tawa, brush with ghee.
3. Pour a ladle of batter, spread evenly. Cook 2 mins per side.
4. Serve with Curd. High protein, zero wheat!

4. 12-Minute One-Pot Veggie Dalia (Broken Wheat)

1. Heat a pressure cooker. Add 1 tsp ghee, jeera, and 1 spoon of Base Masala.
2. Add half a cup of washed Dalia (low GI substitute for rice).

3. Throw in a handful of pre-chopped mixed veggies (beans, carrots, cauliflower).
4. Add 1.5 cups of water. Close lid, wait for 2 whistles. Done!

■ Quick Tips for Speed

- **Buy Pre-peeled Garlic / Ginger-Garlic Paste:** It's worth the slight extra cost if it saves you the tedious peeling process on a busy Wednesday.
- **Frozen Peas & Spinach:** Don't be afraid of frozen veggies. They are flash-frozen at peak ripeness and retain their nutrients. They save incredible amounts of prep time.
- **Multitask:** While the pan is heating, you should be rolling the roti. While the dal is boiling, you should be making the salad.